Bar Model Builder

TEACHER KEY

2nd Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Show word problems with tape diagrams: part-part-whole stories and compare stories. Hide the unknown, write the equation and check the answer. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. The parts are 26 and 18. What is the whole?

44 (26 + 18 = 44)

2. The whole is 50 and one part is 32. What is the other part?

18 (32 + ? = 50, or 50 − 32 = 18)

3. Max read 64 pages. Zoe read 39 pages. How many more pages did Max read?

25 more (64 − 39 = 25)

4. Sam had some marbles. He got 15 more. Now he has 40. How many did he have at first?

25 (? + 15 = 40)

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Explore more

5. Draw a bar model for 57 − 23 and solve it.

Whole 57, one part 23, the other part is 34

6. Find two parts that make a whole of 100.

Any pair that adds to 100, for example 60 and 40

Reflect

7. Reflect: How does a bar model help you choose to add or subtract?

If the whole is missing, add the parts. If a part is missing, subtract the known part from the whole.

Teacher notes

- Read the story aloud first; students decide which box gets the question mark before touching the tool.
- Ask for both equations for a missing part: 24 + ? = 37 and 37 − 24 = ?
- In Compare, ask “how many more” and “how many fewer” about the same picture.

Standards: 2.OA.A.1, 2.NBT.B.5. Accept any correct answer where several are possible, and ask students to explain with the tool’s picture.